R&D | RetailPulse

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Start Here: Project Map

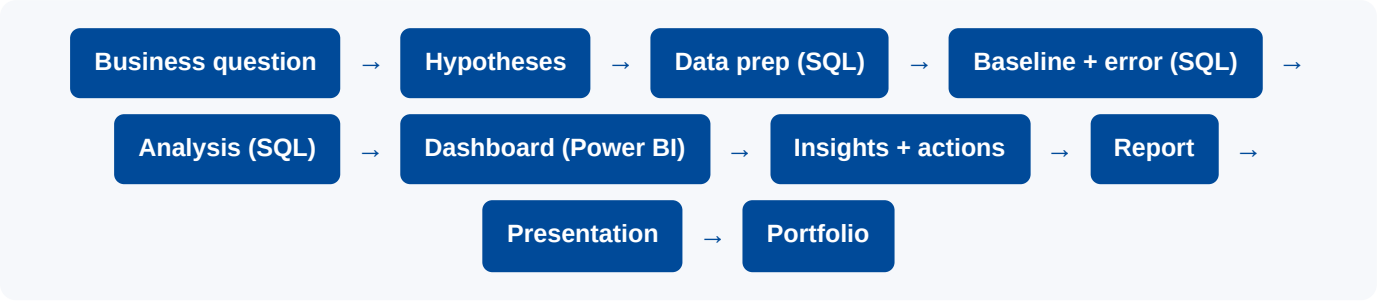
> **In simple words**
>
> This is the map of the whole project. It shows the order of work and which document helps at each step.

What this project is

RetailPulse is a grocery retail team. We study daily sales from the Kaggle **Store Sales - Time Series Forecasting** data. We build a **simple baseline forecast** in SQL, measure its error, and explain **where, when and why** demand is hard to predict. Then we tell the business what to do about it.

> **Your lane: Insights Analyst**
>
> You are the person who talks to the business, finds the story in the data, and helps people decide. SQL and Power BI are your tools. **The recommendation is the product.**

Project flow



Which document to use, and when

Doc	Name	Use it when	You produce
01	Project Charter	Day 1: define the problem and the decisions	Problem statement
02	Stakeholder Needs	Day 1: gather demand (requirements)	Requirement log
03	Data Dictionary and Model	Before writing SQL	Clean tables, holiday flag
04	Error Metric Framework	Before calculating error	Metric views
05	SQL Analysis Specification	While doing analysis	12 analysis outputs
06	Power BI Requirements	While building the dashboard	5-page dashboard
07	Python (Optional)	Only for quick charts	2-3 charts
08	Report Guidelines	While writing the report	Final report
09	Plan and QA Checklist	Daily, and before sharing	Checked work
10	Analyst Guide	When you feel lost	Clear thinking
11	Fast Track Steps	Every day: what to do next	Finished project
12	Hypothesis and Insight Playbook	While turning numbers into insights	Insight log
13	Executive Summary and Presentation	Last stage	Summary, slides
14	Interview and Portfolio Guide	After the project	Resume, README, story

Five rules of an Insights project

1. Every number must answer a business question.
2. Every finding needs a **so what?** and a recommended action.
3. Always compare. A number alone means nothing. Compare with another group, period or the overall value.
4. **Never invent numbers.** Our data has no price or cost. Measure impact in units, not money.
5. Be honest about limits. Say what the data cannot tell us.

Folder structure

```
D:\Project\Demand Forecasting Analysis\
  00_Project_Documents\        (this pack)
  01_Datasets\raw\             (Kaggle CSVs - never edit)
  01_Datasets\processed\       (SQL outputs)
  02_SQL_Scripts\              (numbered .sql files)
  03_PowerBI\                  (.pbix)
  04_Report\                   (final report)
  05_Presentation\             (slides)
  06_Python_Optional\          (quick charts)
  07_Screenshots\              (for README)
  README.md
```

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